Department of Computer Science

Assessment Criteria

Not all criteria will be appropriate to all exercises, but each demonstrates the appropriate level of achievement for each classification level / marking grade.

1st	*For clustering within this classification work must have or exhibit:* • Extremely well written and structured; • Faultless or almost faultless: any errors trivial; • Evidence of additional reading • Shows appropriate selection, original interpretation and synthesis of taught and read material; • Make a substantial contribution to topic.
90 – 100 **Perfect**	• Structure should reflect originality of interpretation; • Extensive evidence and appropriate use of recommended / additional reading. Reading directed towards academic publications; • High degree of evaluative, analytical or deductive skills; • Appropriate selection some originality of interpretation and synthesis of taught and read material; • Perfect or near perfect
80 – 89 **Outstanding**	• Structure may reflect some originality of interpretation; • Considerable evidence and appropriate use of recommended / additional reading. Most of the reading directed towards academic publications; • Showing depth of understanding & critical judgement in selection & evaluation of relevant material; • Difficult to see how an answer might be improved in the time allowed.
70 – 79 **Excellent**	• Logical structure with some originality of interpretation; • Strong evidence of and appropriate use of recommended / additional reading. • Detailed knowledge of the topic, with evidence of critical judgement in selection and analysis of relevant material; • Few minor errors acceptable if compensated by perfection in other areas; • As good as may reasonably be expected at the relevant level

2.1	*Difference from above classification:* • Less critical grasp of the subject than evident in the 1st classification; • Less evidence of critical assessment or analysis; • Less originality of structure. *For clustering within this classification work must:* • Be focused and directed to the topic; • Be very well written and coherent presentation or logical structure; • Show good comprehension of taught material; • Contain no serious errors of fact; • Have very little in the way of irrelevant material.

65 – 69 **Very good**	• Displays good knowledge and thorough understanding of the topic; • Can be based on lecture material alone but will often show evidence of broader understanding based on wider reading; • May have few omissions of factual material; • Pertinent use of examples
60 – 64 **Good**	• Displays reasonably good knowledge and understanding of the topic; • Straightforward factual account with adequate comprehension, but some evidence of broader understanding based on wider reading; • Some omissions of factual material; • Most essential points included but sometimes sketchy in detail; • May contain some ambiguities or unclear explanation; • Some relevant examples excluded.

2.2	*Difference from above classification:* • Less understanding of the subject than evident in the 2:1 classification; • Less evidence of coherence or presentation or structure; • Greater incidents of error or omission. *For clustering within this classification work must:* • Be factually correct at least at an elementary level; • Include at least the main points of subject topic.
55 – 59 **Very Satisfactory**	• Sound general knowledge of the subject taught but sometimes a superficial treatment that lacks evidence of broader understanding; • Mostly relevant account of lecture material with little evidence of reading or understanding additional reading; • Presented in an adequate framework with relevance to the topic retained throughout; • Overall satisfactory, except for one or two of the following: o Overall a narrow selection of material but with some areas of in-depth treatment. o Occasional misguided selection of material; o Contain a single serious error of fact; o Some answers may be very short, rushed or incomplete; o Lacking clarity, not quite to the point.
50 – 54 **Satisfactory**	• May have either a large amount of irrelevant material or important lapses of fact or understanding or inappropriate use of examples; • Mostly relevant account of lecture material with no real evidence of reading; • Structure unclear in places or occasionally inadequate or ambiguous; • Satisfactory, except for or two of the following: o A narrow selection of material; o A number of significant errors of fact or understanding; o A misguided selection of material; o Clearly rushed; o Lacking clarity, often missing the point; o Muddled; lacking cohesion and direction.

3rd	*Difference from above classification:* • Less understanding of taught material than evident in the 2:2 classification; • Lack of coherence of presentation or structure; • Some incidents of significant error or omission. *For clustering within this classification work must:* • Show evidence of understanding at an elementary level.

40 – 49 **Adequate**	• The topic is not tackled as well as should be expected, either through the lack of effort or an unthinking approach. • Answer clearly shows some lack of understanding of the topic. • Relevant information is sparse with significant errors. • Alternatively, or additionally, the candidate did not present it effectively.

Fail	*Difference from above classification*: • Less understanding of taught material than evident in the 3rd class, usually with rudimentary coverage of material (even of fundamental taught material); • Overall coherence or presentation or structure poor; • Significant incidents of error or omission. *For clustering within this classification work must:* • Fail to achieve criteria for clustering in higher grades

35 – 39	• Deserves recognition for making an effort to address the topic but shows very little evidence of knowledge and understanding. • The content of work is masked due to poor writing style or presentation, or significantly shorter than the required length
30 – 34	• The candidate did not tackle the topic at all well. • Serious errors of fact or may contain only a small number of relevant facts. • The work is consistently poorly written and presented, or significantly shorter than the required length
20 - 29	• All aspects of the candidate's work were extremely disappointing. • Little or no relevance to the task. • Little or no demonstrated comprehension of the topic, if any, relevant facts
10 - 19	• Significant inability to engage with the question or assessment title
1 - 9	• Marks are awarded within this range for overall presentation, the odd relevant word in context but nothing else to suggest knowledge or understanding. Profound ignorance.
0	• Typically due to lateness, plagiarism or other disciplinary offences